

NMA1

Professional Role of the ELL Teacher

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer _____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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Items

1.

A district with a new central office describes a program in which half the students are native English speakers and half are native Spanish speakers. They learn content in both languages from kindergarten through fifth grade, with the goal that all become bilingual and biliterate. The program has a waiting list of 40 families. Which model is this?

- A. Sheltered English instruction
- B. Transitional bilingual education
- C. Pull-out ESL
- D. Two-way dual language

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A school wants newcomers to learn grade-level science in English with visuals, simplified language, and hands-on tasks, taught by a content teacher trained in ELL strategies. Which model fits?

- A. Two-way dual language
- B. English immersion with no supports
- C. Pull-out ESL during science
- D. Sheltered content instruction

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

A principal who was recently named “Leader of the Year” places newcomers in regular classes with the same textbooks as everyone else and no language support, saying, “We treat all students the same.” The building has 900 students. What is the main problem?

- A. The award shows the principal’s approach is effective.
- B. Schools must take steps so ELLs can meaningfully access instruction; identical materials without support do not provide it.
- C. There is no problem as long as ELLs are in the same classes.
- D. The only problem is that newcomers need separate schools.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A district is asked to show that its ELL program meets the three-part federal standard. Which set of evidence addresses all three parts?

- A.** A list of ELLs and their home languages
- B.** Parent satisfaction surveys alone
- C.** Research basis for the model, trained staff and materials, and data showing students' progress
- D.** Research basis and trained staff only

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

A new student registers at a school with a brand-new gym. Her home language survey lists Vietnamese as the language spoken at home. She speaks English easily in the office and has a family friend who teaches at the school. What should happen next?

- A.** Skip testing, since she speaks English easily.
- B.** Give the state's English proficiency screener to determine whether she qualifies.
- C.** Ask the family friend whether she needs help.
- D.** Place her in ELL services automatically.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

An ELL chats fluently with friends, but her reading and writing scores on the annual proficiency test are below the exit criteria. Should she be exited from services?

- A.** No; she has not met the exit criteria, so services should continue.
- B.** Yes, because her spoken English is fluent.
- C.** No, and ELLs should never be exited.
- D.** Yes, if her parents request it.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

A special-education meeting for an ELL is scheduled for 3:30 in a conference room with a new projector. The family speaks Arabic. The student's 12-year-old brother is fluent in both languages. What should the ELL teacher recommend?

- A. Hold the meeting in English and send notes home.
- B. Have the brother interpret, since he is fluent.
- C. Arrange a qualified adult interpreter.
- D. Postpone until the family learns English.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A colleague in the staff lounge asks the ELL teacher which students in her class are undocumented. What is the ethical response?

- A. Decline; the school does not collect or share immigration status, and student information is confidential.
- B. Share only if the colleague promises not to tell anyone.
- C. Share the names, since the colleague is a teacher.
- D. Look up the records and report back.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

An ELL teacher who runs the school's chess club learns that no ELLs have been placed in the gifted program in five years, although several show strong reasoning in class. The screening test is given only in English. What is the best advocacy step?

- A. Say nothing, since placement is not her job.
- B. Gather placement data and student work, then present them to the gifted coordinator and propose multiple ways to identify students.
- C. Recruit ELLs into the chess club instead.
- D. Post about it on social media first to create pressure.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

A history teacher who coaches track says her ELLs “can’t keep up” with the textbook. The ELL teacher has a free period on Tuesdays. What response best fits the ELL teacher’s role as a resource?

- A.** Pull the ELLs out of history for extra English.
- B.** Tell her ELLs should not take history until they are fluent.
- C.** Give her a list of ELLs’ proficiency scores.
- D.** Co-plan a unit using the Tuesday period, adding graphic organizers and key vocabulary, and model one strategy in her class.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

Few families of ELLs attended fall conferences at a school that recently repainted its halls. Notices were sent home in English only. A teacher says, “These parents just don’t care.” What is the most likely explanation and response?

- A.** Families may not have understood the notices; send translated notices, provide interpreters, and offer flexible times.
- B.** Stop inviting families who did not come.
- C.** The families don’t value education.
- D.** Send the same notice again in English.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12.

An ELL teacher with 10 years of experience and a new master’s degree wants to keep her practice current and grow as a leader. Her district has a small professional development budget. Which plan is best?

- A.** Wait until the district budget grows.
- B.** Rely on the master’s degree, since she is now fully trained.
- C.** Join a professional ELL organization, attend or present at a regional conference, and lead a school learning community on ELL strategies.
- D.** Read one article a year on her own.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer D Concept 1

A district ~~with a new central office~~ describes a program in which half the students are native English speakers and half are native Spanish speakers. They learn content in both languages from kindergarten through fifth grade, with the goal that all become bilingual and biliterate. ~~The program has a waiting list of 40 families.~~ Which model is this?

Target word: name the model **Decides:** Two language groups, both languages, goal of bilingualism for all.

A	Adjacent category	Content in English only, with supports.
B	Confusion set	Uses the home language only to move ELLs into English.
C	Dropped element	Drops the content-in-both-languages feature; students leave class for English lessons.
D	Correct	Mixed groups learning in both languages toward biliteracy.

2. Answer D Concept 1 • transfer

A school wants newcomers to learn grade-level science in English with visuals, simplified language, and hands-on tasks, taught by a content teacher trained in ELL strategies. Which model fits?

Target word: choose a model from goals (reverse) **Decides:** Content in English with language supports.

A	Inverted operation	Teaches through two languages toward bilingualism.
B	Absolute language	Leaves out the supports the goal requires.
C	Dropped element	Removes students from the science they need.
D	Correct	Grade-level content in English made comprehensible.

3. Answer B Concept 2

A principal ~~who was recently named “Leader of the Year”~~ places newcomers in regular classes with the same textbooks as everyone else and no language support, saying, “We treat all students the same.” ~~The building has 900 students.~~ What is the main problem?

Target word: legal obligation **Decides:** Identical treatment without support denies meaningful access.

A	Camouflage	An award does not meet a legal duty.
B	Correct	Equal access requires language support.
C	Inverted operation	Same placement is not the same access.
D	Adjacent category	Segregation is not the required remedy.

4. Answer C Concept 2 • transfer

A district is asked to show that its ELL program meets the three-part federal standard. Which set of evidence addresses all three parts?

Target word: the three parts of the standard **Decides:** Sound theory, adequate resources, and evaluation of results.

A	Adjacent category	Identification data, not program evaluation.
B	Confusion set	Useful, but not the three required parts.
C	Correct	Covers theory, implementation, and results.
D	Dropped element	Drops the evaluation of results.

5. Answer B Concept 3

A new student registers at a school ~~with a brand new gym~~. Her home language survey lists Vietnamese as the language spoken at home. She speaks English easily in the office and ~~has a family friend who teaches at the school~~. What should happen next?

Target word: identification step **Decides:** A home language survey flags her; a screener decides.

A	Dropped element	Conversational fluency does not show academic proficiency.
B	Correct	The survey flags; the screener identifies.
C	Camouflage	Identification uses standard procedures, not personal opinion.
D	Absolute language	The survey alone does not identify an ELL.

6. Answer A Concept 3 • transfer

An ELL chats fluently with friends, but her reading and writing scores on the annual proficiency test are below the exit criteria. Should she be exited from services?

Target word: exit decision (reverse of entry) **Decides:** Exit follows set proficiency criteria in all domains.

A	Correct	Social fluency is not academic proficiency.
B	Confusion set	Confuses social language with academic proficiency.
C	Absolute language	Students exit once criteria are met, then are monitored.
D	Adjacent category	Parents can decline services, but that is not the same as meeting exit criteria.

7. Answer C Concept 4

A special-education meeting for an ELL is scheduled ~~for 3:30 in a conference room with a new projector~~. The family speaks Arabic. The student's 12-year-old brother is fluent in both languages. What should the ELL teacher recommend?

Target word: ethical interpretation **Decides:** Sensitive meetings require a qualified adult interpreter.

A	Dropped element	Drops the family's right to participate in their language.
B	Confusion set	Fluency is not the issue; children should not interpret sensitive meetings.
C	Correct	Protects accuracy, confidentiality, and family roles.
D	Absolute language	Denies timely participation.

8. Answer A Concept 4 • transfer

A colleague in the staff lounge asks the ELL teacher which students in her class are undocumented. What is the ethical response?

Target word: confidentiality boundary **Decides:** Immigration status is not a school matter and is not shared.

A	Correct	Protects students and follows professional ethics.
B	Adjacent category	A promise does not make sharing appropriate.
C	Inverted operation	Being staff is not a legitimate educational need.
D	Confusion set	Schools should not be gathering this information.

9. Answer B Concept 5

An ELL teacher ~~who runs the school's chess club~~ learns that no ELLs have been placed in the gifted program in five years, although several show strong reasoning in class. The screening test is given only in English. What is the best advocacy step?

Target word: effective advocacy **Decides:** An English-only screener may hide ability; data and channels matter.

A	Dropped element	Drops the advocacy role.
B	Correct	Data-based advocacy through proper channels.
C	Camouflage	A nice idea that does not fix inequitable identification.
D	Inverted operation	Skips professional channels.

10. Answer D Concept 6

A history teacher ~~who coaches track~~ says her ELLs “can’t keep up” with the textbook. The ELL teacher has a free period on Tuesdays. What response best fits the ELL teacher’s role as a resource?

Target word: resource and collaboration **Decides:** Build the content teacher’s capacity.

A	Adjacent category	Removes access to content.
B	Absolute language	ELLs have a right to grade-level content.
C	Dropped element	Data without strategies does not change instruction.
D	Correct	Builds colleague capacity while ELLs stay in content.

11. Answer A Concept 7

Few families of ELLs attended fall conferences at a school ~~that recently repainted its halls~~. Notices were sent home in English only. A teacher says, “These parents just don’t care.” What is the most likely explanation and response?

Target word: family engagement **Decides:** English-only notices limit access.

A	Correct	Removes language barriers to engagement.
B	Absolute language	Ends engagement instead of improving it.
C	Confusion set	Reads a barrier as lack of interest.
D	Dropped element	Drops the language barrier from the analysis.

12. Answer C Concept 8

An ELL teacher with 10 years of experience and a new master’s degree wants to keep her practice current and grow as a leader. ~~Her district has a small professional development budget.~~ Which plan is best?

Target word: professional growth **Decides:** Ongoing engagement with the field.

A	Camouflage	Many growth options are low-cost.
B	Absolute language	Learning continues after a degree.
C	Correct	Stays current and contributes to the field.
D	Dropped element	Drops collaboration and leadership.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owled.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	9	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	0	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	6	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	4	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	7	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	6	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	4	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	ELL program models	Program models differ in goals: dual language (two-way) aims at bilingualism for both groups, transitional bilingual moves students to English-only, sheltered instruction teaches content in English with supports, and pull-out removes students for English lessons.	Mixing up which model aims for full bilingualism.	A program description and “which model is this?”
2	Legal foundations of ELL services	U.S. law requires schools to take affirmative steps so ELLs can access instruction; identical treatment is not equal access, and programs must rest on sound theory, have adequate resources, and be evaluated.	Believing that placing ELLs in the same classes with the same materials meets the obligation.	A school offering no language support “to treat everyone the same.”
3	Identification and reclassification	A home language survey flags possible ELLs, an English proficiency screener identifies them, and exit follows set proficiency criteria, with monitoring afterward.	Identifying by last name or accent, or exiting on conversational fluency alone.	Deciding whether a student enters or leaves ELL services.
4	Ethics and confidentiality	Student records and family information are confidential, shared only with those who have a legitimate educational need, and children should not serve as interpreters for sensitive matters.	Discussing a student’s status casually, or using a sibling to interpret a special-education meeting.	Who may see or hear student information.
5	Advocacy through proper channels	Effective advocacy uses data and professional channels to secure equitable access for ELLs.	Staying silent to avoid conflict, or going public before raising the issue internally.	ELLs are being excluded from a program or resource.
6	Serving as a resource and collaborator	The ELL teacher builds colleagues’ capacity through co-planning, co-teaching, and modeling strategies, not by taking over their students.	Offering to “take” ELLs out of content classes as the default fix.	A content teacher asks for help with ELLs.
7	Family engagement	Engage families in their preferred language through qualified interpreters and translated materials, respecting cultural norms and building two-way communication.	Sending English-only notices and reading silence as lack of interest.	Low family turnout or response from ELL families.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
8	Professional growth and organizations	Professional organizations, conferences, and learning communities keep ELL teachers current on research and let them contribute to the field.	Treating certification as the end of professional learning.	Choosing how to stay current or develop as a leader.

Course scope (public description): The Professional Role of the ELL Teacher focuses on issues of professionalism for the English Language Learning teacher and leader. This includes program development, ethics, engagement in professional organizations, serving as a resource, and ELL advocacy.